Personal Development Plan (PDP)

Student Name: [S.U.Rashmi]

Student ID: [IT23818552]

Module: IT2100 – Employability Skills Development

Year 2, Semester 2 – 2025

1. Self-Assessment

To assess my present status regarding academic, personal, and professional development, I performed a SWOT analysis on myself.

My strengths include effective communication abilities in both Sinhala and English, which facilitate collaboration in group work and presentations. I possess strong time management skills, enabling me to successfully balance my academic responsibilities and extracurricular activities. I am a dependable team member in group projects. I enjoy addressing challenges through innovative technological methods.

However, I acknowledge my weaknesses, including a lack of confidence when speaking in public to larger audiences. Additionally, I believe I need to enhance my technical skills, particularly in advanced programming. When my workload escalates, I tend to experience stress and procrastinate.

Opportunities include access to career counseling services at my university and the chance to network with industry professionals via LinkedIn and university events.

Threats include the competitive nature of the IT industry, which necessitates both technical and soft skills. Additionally, there is a risk of lagging behind in rapidly evolving technologies if continuous learning is overlooked.

According to the Johari window model, I keep some personal feelings private. I value honestly collaboration and lifelong learning.

2. Goal Setting

Based on my self-assessment, I have set the following smart goals.

<u>Short-term goals (within 6 months)</u>

Improve my public speaking skill by practicing presentations and viva in my university. Watching online videos about programming languages (java, Python) and developing my coding skill. Develop a LinkedIn profile and update it with academic achievements and projects.

Medium term goals (6 months-2 years)

Obtain an internship at a well-regarded IT company to acquire industry experience, enhance stress management through the practice of mindfulness and effective planning, lead a group project during my university years to cultivate leadership skills.

Long term goals (2–5 years)

Graduated with strong technical and soft skills. Aim to become a leader within 5 years of starting my career.

3. Action Planning

To achieve my public speaking, I will also volunteer for presentations in class since May 2025.

I have been developing my programming skills through online platforms, specifically YouTube, from October 2025 to January 2026.

I will improve stress management by practicing daily meditation using meditation apps and organizing my schedule with google calendar starting from May 2025 onwards.

To develop my leadership skills, I serve as the team leader for my group project.

For my internship, I plan to revise my CV and LinkedIn profile by January 2026, participate in university career fairs, and connect with industry professionals. I aim to submit a applications by January 2026 to enhance my opportunities.

4. Monitoring and Evaluation Strategy

To ensure progress, I will monitor and evaluate my personal development plan regularly.

- I maintain a detailed monthly journal to carefully track my personal improvements, note challenges I face, and reflect on lessons learned from both academic and extracurricular activities.
- I will reevaluate my goals every two months, using a structured checklist to measure my progress, identify areas that need more focus, and adjust my action plan as necessary.
- I actively seek constructive feedback from lecturers, mentors, and peers regarding my communication skills, technical abilities, and overall performance to ensure continuous development.

- I will leverage my LinkedIn profile and GitHub repository to document and showcase my achievements, completed projects, and coding progress as tangible evidence of my personal and professional growth.

5. Personal Insight and Motivation

My motivation for setting these goals stems from my vision of becoming a highly skilled and impactful IT professional who can contribute meaningfully to the field. My career vision is to become a software engineer, where I can design and develop innovative solutions that solve real-world problems. I am truly passionate about problem-solving, building efficient systems, and continuously learning new technologies to stay ahead in this ever-evolving industry. My life purpose is to use technology as a tool to create meaningful changes, improving people's lives while achieving personal growth and long-term career satisfaction.

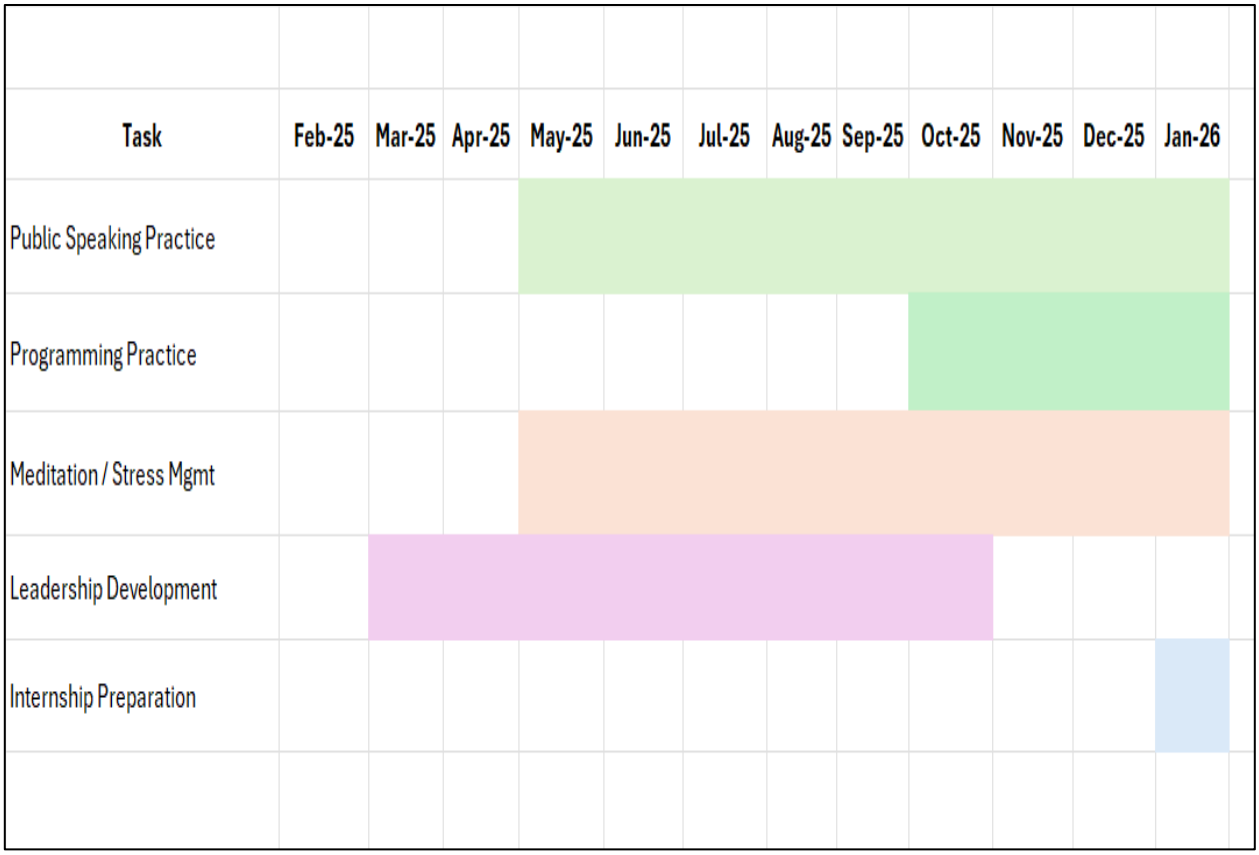
6. Presentation and Communication

I have presented this Personal Development Plan in a clear and organized way, using proper headings and sub-sections so that each part can be easily understood. I made sure to use formal but simple academic language, paying attention to grammar and clarity. To support my ideas, I included tools such as SWOT analysis, the Johari Window, and SMART goals, which help to explain my reflections more effectively. I also added a Gantt chart to visually show my action plan and timelines. By combining written explanations with visual tools, I aimed to make this PDP professional, easy to follow, and well-structured.

7. Use of Supporting Tools and Evidence

To strengthen and validate this PDP, I have used the following supporting tools and evidence:

- **SWOT Analysis**: Used to identify my strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats.
- **Johari Window**: Applied to reflect on self-awareness and personal values.
- **CV Draft**: Updated with technical skills, extracurricular involvement, and teamwork experience.
- **Past Academic Grades & Group Project Feedback**: Evidence of strong teamwork and communication skills.
- **GitHub Repository**: Used to display coding projects and programming practice progress.


Task
Feb-25
Mar-25
Apr-25
May-25
Jun-25
Jul-25
Aug-25
Sep-25
Oct-25
Nov-25
Dec-25
Jan-26
Public Speaking Practice
Programming Practice
Meditation / Stress Mgmt
Leadership Development
Internship Preparation